



EMERGENT LAYER

The forest has many layers, which give animals different places to live. Soaring above the rest of the forest, a few extra-tall trees form the highest layer. These giants make good perches for birds.



SUNLIGHT



HARPY EAGLE
Mexico to South America



BLUE MORPHO BUTTERFLY
Central and South America



SCARLET MACAW
Mexico to South America



HANGING PARROT
Southeast Asia



DENDROBIUM ORCHID
Southeast Asia

CANOPY

Most of the forest trees have broad crowns that form a continuous layer of branches called the canopy. This is where many of the animals live and feed, high above the forest floor.



SUNLIGHT



BLUE POISON-DART FROG
South America



RED-EYED TREE FROG
Central America



GREEN TREE PYTHON
New Guinea; Australia



MISTLETOE CACTUS
Central America



SHINING-GREEN HUMMINGBIRD
South America



WHITE-THROATED TOUCAN
South America



AFRICAN GREY PARROT
West and Central Africa

UNDERSTOREY

Beneath the canopy is a layer of smaller trees and shrubs that can grow in the shade of the tall trees. It is alive with insects, lizards, and tree-living snakes.



SUNLIGHT



MAGNIFICENT BIRD OF PARADISE
Papua New Guinea



EMERALD TREE BOA
South America



PARSON'S CHAMELEON
Madagascar



CHIMPANZEE
West to Central Africa



FRANQUET'S FRUIT BAT
West and Central Africa



KUHL'S FLYING GECKO
Southeast Asia

FOREST FLOOR

The dim light at ground level means that few plants can grow, except in clearings. Fallen fruit and seeds provide food for small animals, which are hunted by predators such as jaguars.



SUNLIGHT



RAFFLESIA
Southeast Asia



KING COBRA
South and Southeast Asia



GOLDEN SCARAB
South America



EMPEROR SCORPION
Africa



MANDRILL
Central Africa



WESTERN GORILLA
Central Africa

RIVER

Thick vegetation grows along the sunlit banks of rivers. In the rainy season, some rivers swell so high that they overflow and flood vast areas of the surrounding forest.



SUNLIGHT



MADAGASCAN TOMATO FROGS
Madagascar



MATAMATA TURTLE
South America



PIRANHA
South America



CAPYBARA
South America



NILE CROCODILE
Africa